PART II - HISPANIOLA, DESTINATION OF THE VOYAGE THAT CHANGED THE HISTORY OF HUMANITY.

THE WONDERS OF THE FIRST ADVENTURES IN AMERICA



IVÁN GATÓN

Born in Sabana Grande de Boyá, province of Monte Plata, Dominican Republic, and from an early age, his vocation as a teacher became evident. He lived there until he finished high school and then moved to the city of Santo Domingo to study law at the Autonomous University of Santo Domingo.

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He has completed advanced studies in diplomacy, international law, political science, trade and international relations in various countries, such as Spain, United States of America, The People's Republic of China, Taiwan, Belgium, Japan, Germany, Mexico, Argentina and Holland.

He has been a guest lecturer at Asian, European and Latin American universities, and teaches in both, the Dominican Republic and Spain, master's degrees and specialized courses in geopolitics, international relations and international law.



Professor Gatón has published several books and a large number of articles on international relations and geopolitics. He is currently a career diplomat with the rank of ambassador in the Ministry of Foreign Affairs of the Dominican Republic.

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WORDS BY THE AUTHOR

The historical dignity of our people must be recontextualized: it would be a serious mistake to overlook its origins, as well as the events that took place in what today we call the Dominican Republic and the actors involved, all of which influenced forever the changes that humanity experienced since the arrival of Europeans on October 12, 1492 in the so-called "New World".

What motivated us to make the decision to create a comic book that would allow Dominican children and young people to get closer to their historical links is the undeniable fact that we are not aware of how important and transcendental is our territorial space in the process known as modernity.

Peoples without memory are condemned to disappear in the fortuitous coming and going of the times, and this work is the modest contribution I would like to make in these crucial moments for the future of the Dominican Republic.

OUR GRATITUDE

To my father, Pedro Ernesto Gaton; to my mother, Felicita Altagracia Rosa Franco; to all my siblings; to my family, both maternal and paternal, who have always accompanied me during my still short course of life.

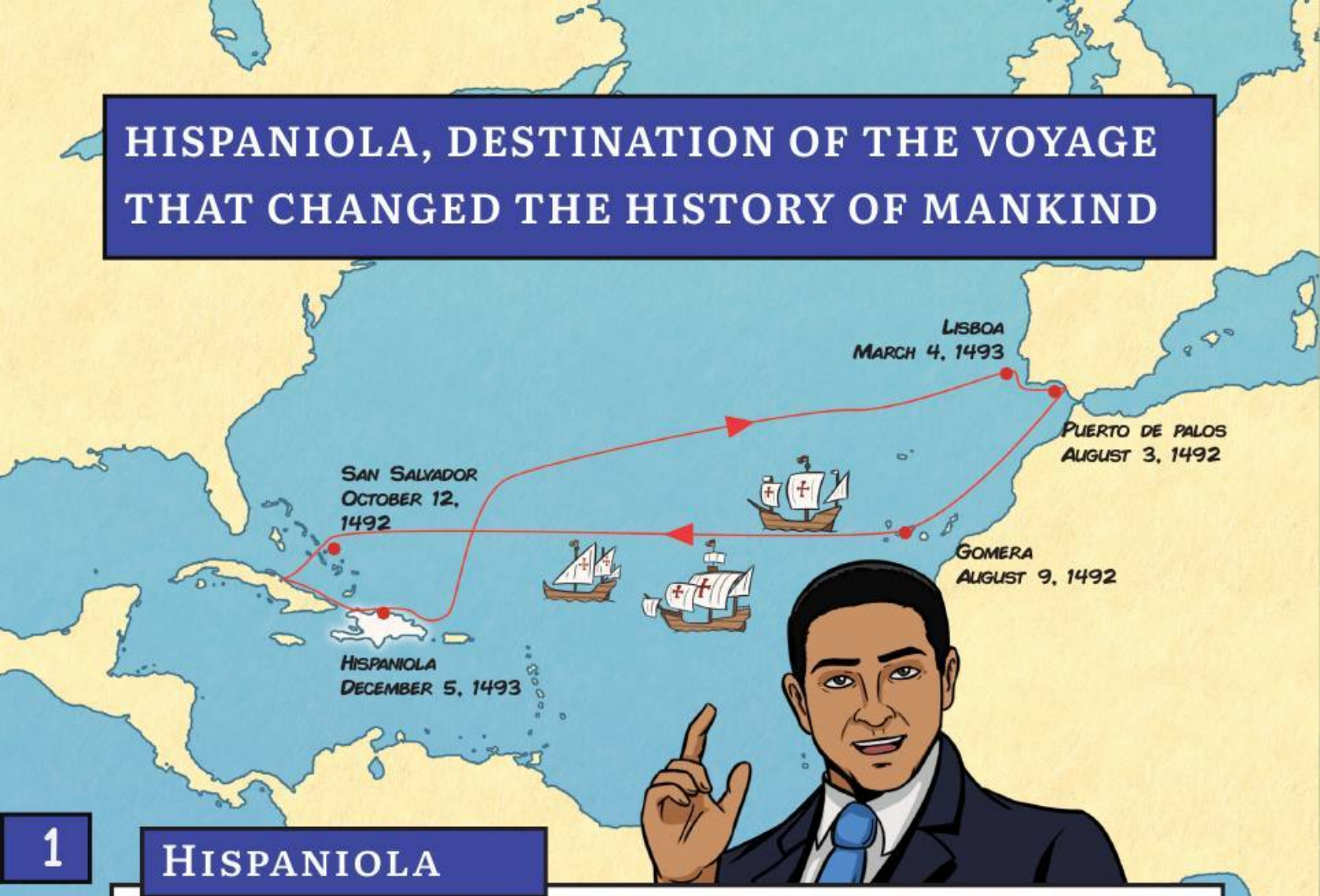
In a very special way, to those who inspired and made the comic possible: Carolyn Gatón Pichardo, Pedro Ernesto Gaton Pichardo, Carolyn Cort, Mrs. TSR, Carrie Friesen, Bonny Smith Kurtz, Hector Jose Rizek, Don Teofilo -Quico- Tabar and Josefina Severino.

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HISPANIOLA, DESTINATION OF THE VOYAGE THAT CHANGED THE HISTORY OF MANKIND



1

HISPANIOLA

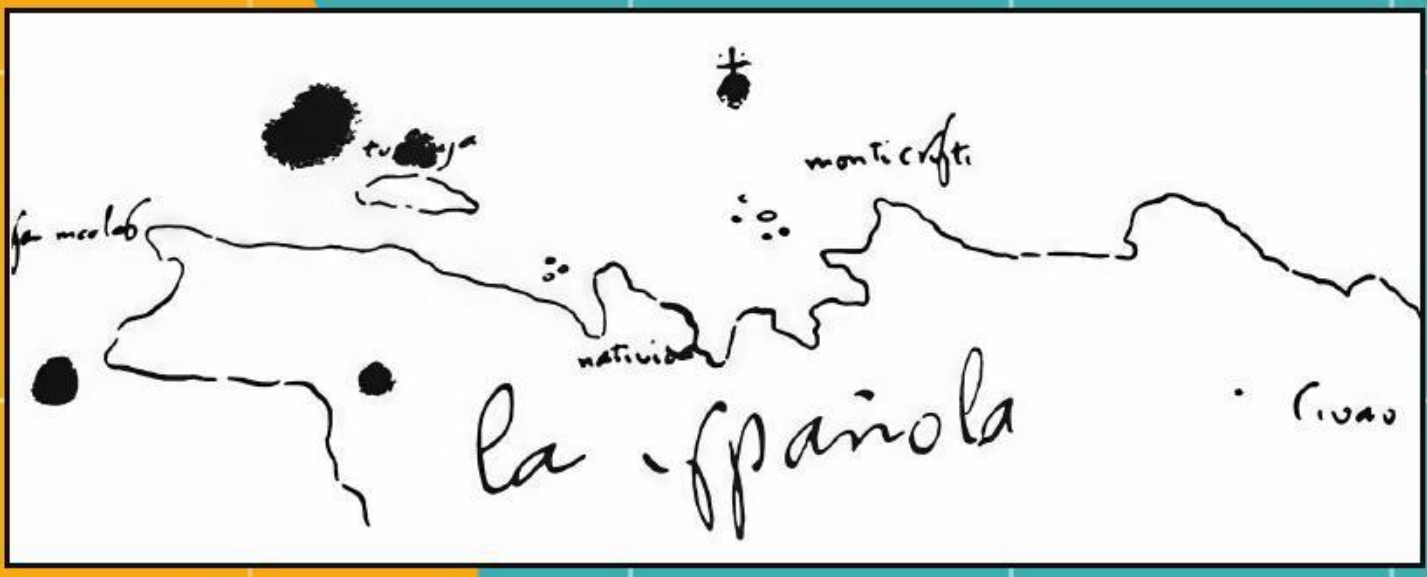
THE ARRIVAL OF COLUMBUS TO HISPANIOLA PUT THE WORLD IN CONTACT WITH AN UNKNOWN HEMISPHERE OF THE EARTH: IT WAS THE BEGINNING OF A NEW ERA. SINCE THE EUROPEANS ARRIVED IN THE NEW WORLD THIS PLACE HAS BEEN THE CRADLE OF THE LARGEST NUMBER OF ANCIENT EVENTS RELATED TO THE CONQUEST OF AMERICA BY SPAIN.

WITH THE ESTABLISHMENT OF THE CHRISTMAS FORT, ON DECEMBER 25, 1492, BUILT WITH THE REMAINS OF THE SANTA MARIA SHIP, WITH CAPTAIN DIEGO DE ARANA, THE SPANIARDS LEFT THE FIRST EUROPEAN CONSTRUCTION IN AMERICA.

THE FOUNDATION OF THE FIRST CITY OF AMERICA, "LA ISABELA" OR "VILLA ISABELA", ON JANUARY 6, 1494, LOCATED IN THE CURRENT PROVINCE OF PUERTO PLATA, ON THE SECOND VOYAGE OF ADMIRAL CHRISTOPHER COLUMBUS, INITIATED A NEW STAGE FOR THE HUMAN SPECIES.

ON THAT SAME DATE, JANUARY 6, 1494, THE SPANISH SPIRITUAL CONQUEST BEGAN WITH THE CELEBRATION OF THE MASS OFFICIATED BY FATHER BERNARDO BOIL AND THE SUBSEQUENT DEDICATION OF FRAY RAMÓN PANÉ TO LEARNING THE NATIVE LANGUAGES IN ORDER TO PREACH THE CHRISTIAN DOCTRINE TO THE ABORIGINES. IT WAS ALSO FRAY PANÉ WHO MANAGED TO BAPTIZE THE FIRST MARTYRS OF CHRISTIANITY IN AMERICA: GUATICABA AND HIS ENTIRE FAMILY.

THE FIRST CARTOGRAPHIC MAP EVER DRAWN OF THE AMERICAS



Cartography, the art of drawing maps, was practiced for the first time in America when in 1492 Columbus drew a view of the north coast of our island in which he included the Saint-Nicolas peninsula, the Tortuga Island, the Fort of Navidad, Montecristi and the territory of "Cibao", a name that sounded similar to "Cipango" to Columbus, with which Marco Polo identified Japan in his work "The Book of Wonders".

This map included the territory from Cape Saint-Nicolas to present-day Sosua, in the province of Puerto Plata. However, Columbus' companion on his first voyage and owner of the ship Santa Maria, Juan de la Cosa, was actually the first to present a cartographic document of America, which, being its author an eyewitness to the encounter with the New World, acquires an added value.

Although it is not exact, it is impressive that the length and location of a place could be located, considering the lack of technical resources in those days.



The map made by Juan de la Cosa, which can be seen in the Naval Museum of Madrid, is a chart 93 cm high by 183 cm wide, drawn on a calfskin parchment. In it the known territories (the Old World) can be distinguished in beige color and the new findings in green color, on the left side.

Isabella I the Catholic, Queen of Castile

Isabella of Castile was a fundamental support for the Genoese navigator Christopher Columbus and his project to reach Cipango, in Japan, and Cathay, in China, which did not convince the monarchs or the cosmographers of that time.

Thanks to the guidance received by the monarch from her confessors and advisors, Fray Juan Pérez, monk of the Monastery of La Rábida, who always believed in Columbus, and Fray Hernando de Talavera, the "Capitulaciones de Santa Fe" were signed on April 17, 1492, in the town of the same name, on the outskirts of Granada. This document contains the agreements for the expedition to the west.



She was born on April 22, 1451 in Madrigal de las Altas Torres, Avila, Spain. Daughter of John II of Castile and Isabella of Portugal, she died on November 26, 1504 in Medina del Campo.

Although she was not entitled to be queen, the death of her brothers, King Henry IV and Alfonso of Castile, and her decision to prevent the legitimate heir, Juana la Beltraneja from coming to power, paved the way for her coronation.



Ferdinand II of Aragon

Ferdinand II of Aragon. Sos, Zaragoza, 1452. Madrigalejo, Cáceres, 1516. King of Aragon (1479-1516), Sicily (1468-1516), and Naples (1504-1516), and ruler of Castile with his wife Isabella I of Castile (1474-1504).



An irrefutable demonstration of the commitment assumed by Isabella I the Catholic to treat the Indians as Castilian subjects is that the sons of cacique Guacanagarix, whom Columbus took to Spain after his first voyage, were baptized as Don Juan de Castilla and Don Fernando de Aragón, who served as pages of honor of Prince Don Juan, a position that the aristocracy longed for their sons.

As important events attributed to Queen Isabella, historians point out the defense of the Catholic faith, the reconquest of Granada, the conquest of America and the decree of expulsion of the Jews.

It should also be noted that she prevailed over the wishes of her brother King Henry IV, and that on October 19, 1469 she secretly married her second cousin, Ferdinand the Catholic, forging a bull attributed to the pontiff Pius II, who had died five years earlier. This marriage marked the beginning of the diarchy of Castile and Aragon.

After her death, the "Laws of Burgos" were created, which meant the beginning of what in the contemporary world is known as "human rights".

First towns in Hispaniola



5

La Isabela, or Villa Isabela, located in the current province of Puerto Plata, was the first city founded in America. This event took place on January 6, 1494 on the second voyage of Admiral Christopher Columbus.

The city of Santo Domingo was founded by Bartholomew Columbus on August 5, 1496. It was located on the eastern bank of the Ozama River and by then was called "the New Isabela". In 1502, Nicolás de Ovando moved it to the western bank of the same river, giving it its current name.

The following cities were founded in Hispaniola between 1493 and 1508:

Cities founded by Columbus and his family:

1. La Isabela, in 1493.
2. Concepción de la Vega, in 1494.
3. Santo Domingo, in 1496.
4. Santiago de los Caballeros, in 1497.
5. Bonao, in 1498.

Cities founded by Ovando (1502 - 1509):

1. Buenaventura Santa Cruz de Hicayagua.
2. Cotuí.
3. Puerto Real.
4. Lares de Guahaba.
5. Vera Paz (Yaguana).
6. Villanueva de Yaquino.
7. Salvatierra de la Sabana.
8. San Juan de la Maguana.
9. Azua.
10. Salvaleón de Higüey.

The first mestizo

Miguel Diaz de Aux, the son, was born in Santo Domingo in 1496 and he is recognized as the first mestizo of America. He was the son of Miguel Diaz de Aux, the father, and the female cacique Osema, baptized as Catalina. In 1494, Miguel Diaz de Aux, the father, a native of Barbastro, Huesca, kingdom of Aragon, arrived in La Isabela with Bartholomew Columbus. After an altercation in which he thought he had killed another Spaniard, he fled to the south of the island and, in the area of Haina, he joined the aforementioned female cacique, with whom he had two sons, being the first, Miguelico, as his father called him, the only one to survive.

In his will, which he dictated in Seville on July 2, 1504, Mr. Diaz de Aux, father, bequeathed to his son 200 thousand maravedis, a sum that would be doubled if as an adult the young Diaz de Aux opted for the priestly life. At the end of the will there was a loving note: "My son Miguelico, who is in Hispaniola. Because he is of tender age, he is eight years old".



The conqueror of Mexico, viceroyalty of the New Spain, Hernán Cortés, in his letter of relation to King Carlos I of Spain, mentions Miguel Díaz de Aux, who like his father had opted for the military life, among the thirteen captains that accompanied him in the conquest of the city of Tenochtitlán.



It is undeniable that it is in Hispaniola, with Miguelico Diaz de Aux, the son, renowned conqueror of New Spain (today Mexico), and Mencia, the daughter of Higuemota and Hernando de Guevara, where the biological and cultural mixture of different ethnicities began for the first time in the new world.

The first Spanish women in the Americas

The first women to arrive from Europe came in the great fleet of Fray Nicolás de Ovando, commander of the Order of Alcantara and confidant of Queen Isabella the Catholic.

In the fleet of Diego Columbus, who replaced Ovando as governor of Hispaniola in 1509, came not only his wife Maria de Toledo, but also other women who were part of the viceregal court, the first in America. Then, in 1514, the conquistador Pedrarias Dávila arrived in Castilla de Oro, a territory between the Gulf of Urabá, Colombia, and the territory of Veragua in Panama, bordering Costa Rica, accompanied by his wife Isabel de Bobadilla, who became an exceptional example of a woman conqueror, who, according to Fray Bartolomé de Las Casas in his "Histories of the Indies", had little to envy to her male counterparts.



The royal decree of October 13, 1554 allowed married men to come to the Indies without a wife, as long as they paid a bond, but on the condition that this absence should not extend for more than two years under penalty of imprisonment.

A turning point was the ordinance issued by Emperor Charles V in 1530, which prohibited married subjects of Castile from traveling to America without their wives, which also affected the viceroys in their capacity as supreme representatives of the Spanish State in the Indies.

Thus, the female migration arriving in the New World continued to grow, which allowed the formation of a social fabric that, as established by Spanish writer Carmen García in her book "Mujeres Pioneras en la Conquista de América", "it was these who upon embarking to the New World began to form this new system, from which overseas Spain began to be built."

Maria de Toledo, first ruler in the Americas

Wife of Diego, Christopher Columbus' firstborn son, Maria de Toledo was the first lady of the high nobility to come to America.

When in 1514 her husband had to travel to Spain to claim the benefits of the Capitulaciones de Santa Fe, which had been signed by her father and the Catholic Monarchs, she served until 1520 as governor and viceroy of the Indies.

During the exercise of her new functions she promoted the construction of hospitals, schools for native mestizo girls, looms and sewing houses; she defended the natives and administered a sugar mill.

Diego Columbus died in 1526, so in 1530 Maria de Toledo traveled to Spain to claim the inheritance of his seven children, which she achieved in 1541.



Fourteen years passed from her departure to Spain until her return to Santo Domingo in 1544, bringing from Seville the remains of her husband and those of her father-in-law, Christopher Columbus.

A pioneer among the pioneers of colonization, she died on May 11, 1549. She had asked to be buried in the Primate Cathedral of America, in the land she loved so much, Santo Domingo.



Catalina Bustamante

The first teacher in America, born in Llerena, Badajoz, in the bosom of a noble family that was able to give her an education. Spanish writer and researcher Jose Maria Gonzalez Ochoa tells us in his book "Unknown Protagonists of the Conquest of America" that she arrived in Santo Domingo in 1514 with her husband Diego Tinoco. Everything indicates that this one died, since, a few years after her arrival in the Indies, we find her in Mexico, in a period of time not very distant from the concretization of the conquest and domination of the Mexicas.

The first library in America

The first books that arrived in America were brought by Christopher Columbus on his first voyage. Among them mention can be made of Abraham Zacuto's "Almanaque Perpetuo", published in 1478 by this Sephardic Jew from Salamanca, an astronomical reference work that was very useful to the Genoese admiral as well as to many navigators of that time.

In his work "La Española, Epicenter of the Caribbean in the 16th Century", Spanish historian Esteban Mira Caballos writes about the library of Doña Ines de Pena, who is believed to have inherited it from her father Antpn Ruiz, a neighbor of Santo Domingo who seems to have dedicated himself to the trade of literary works.

In the inventory of the books of Doña Ines de Pena, which was made on the occasion of her death in 1521, 128 volumes of religious themes were found, such as gospels and sacramental books, and more than 96 grammar primers to teach children to read.



Newly published books of chivalry in Spanish, such as "Lisuarte de Grecia" by Feliciano de Silva, "La Celestina" or "Tragicomedia de Calixto y Melibea" by Fernando de Rojas, "El Amadís de Gaula" by Garci Rodríguez de Montalvo, "El Libro de los Remedios" by Francisco Petrarca, "Los Milagros de Nuestra Señora" by the poet Gonzalo de Berceo, "El Arte del Bien Morir" by Erasmus of Rotterdam, "Crónica Troyana II" by Homer, printed by Juan de Burgos in 1490, "Eneas" by Virgil, and "La República" by Plato.



For this library and other goods left by Ines, her father, who represented her three children, brought a lawsuit that lasted for seven years, whose decision was in favor of them. This shows us that it is in our island Hispaniola where the first library of America is located, precisely, the one that belonged to Doña Ines de Pena.

Beginning of the global exchange of agricultural products

It was in Mesopotamia, between the Tigris and Euphrates rivers, where the Neolithic revolution began, when human beings stopped being nomads to become sedentary and domesticate the families of wheat, barley, peas, and lentils, among others.

But, in reality, the beginning of food globalization had its milestone when, on September 25, 1493, Christopher Columbus set sail from Cadiz, Spain, on his second voyage, with 1,500 people bringing agricultural products in one of the 17 ships that made up the expedition.



China brought millet and cabbage; Southeast Asia rice and bananas; New Guinea sugar cane; Africa sorghum, African rice and yams, while America brought cocoa, corn, cassava, pumpkin, pineapple, peppers, avocado, beans, tomatoes, quinoa, sweet potatoes, potatoes and sunflowers, among other products.

Columbus arrived again in Hispaniola on November 22, 1493 and received the news that the Spaniards he had left at the Fort of Navidad had died, either because of illness or because the cacique Caonabo had executed them. He decided to found "La Isabela", where he planted the first agricultural products that had been brought from Europe, among them a wild vine, some ears of wheat, chickpeas, sugar cane, and other plants. After touring the Cibao area, he returned to La Isabela, where he arrived on March 29, and there he found the pleasant and satisfactory surprise that the melons that had been planted just 60 days earlier were bearing fruit.

It was in the lands of Hispaniola, to which the chronicles of the time attributed "such fertility that they were capable of bearing fruit twice a year", that the global exchange of agricultural products began.

First sugar production in America



11

With the establishment of the Spaniards in America with the founding of the Villa de La Isabela, named in honor of Queen Isabella of Castile, the need arose to establish cultivation areas to begin agricultural production, which would benefit both the colony and the Spanish Crown, through the export of our products.

As we have already established, it is in La Isabela where the cultivation of the first agricultural products brought by the Europeans from other parts of the world began in America. As far as sugar cane is concerned, which is a grass native to New Guinea, in the continent of Oceania, it was brought to America on Columbus' second voyage from the Canary Islands.

The first chronicler of America, Gonzalo Fernandez de Oviedo, refers that the pioneer in planting sugar cane in sizable quantity was Pedro de Atienza, neighbor of La Concepción de La Vega, and that Miguel Ballester, a Catalan who was the warden there, was the first to produce sugar in the New World.

On a trip from Castilla de Oro, between present-day Panama and Colombia, to Spain in mid-1515, Oviedo refers that six loaves of sugar were brought to the Spanish monarch Ferdinand the Catholic and that "this was the first sugar he saw in these parts".

Fray Tomás Berlanga

Belonging to a family of modest farmers from Berlanga de Duero, located in the province of Soria, autonomous community of Castie and Leon, at an early age he followed in the footsteps of Saint Dominic de Guzman, by belonging to the Dominican order after having studied in the convent of San Esteban in Salamanca.

In 1508, he broadened his preparation in humanism, geography, nautical and natural sciences, and in 1510 he embarked for the island of Hispaniola as part of the second expedition of his priestly order. He was elected prior to the Convent of the Dominican Order in Santo Domingo.

In 1531 he was sent to Mexico as vice-provincial of the Dominicans and, from this date until 1535, he took charge of the bishopric of Panama, which led to his being sent to Lima, Peru, by order of Charles I of Spain and V of the Holy Roman-Germanic Empire, to deal with the disputes of the conquerors Diego de Almagro and Francisco Pizarro.



During that voyage in 1531, the ocean currents took him away from his route and brought him to an archipelago that he would baptize as the "Galapagos Islands", due to the large number of tortoises, or chelonians, that inhabited there.

Fray Tomas de Berlanga recommended the construction of an interoceanic canal in Panama; he introduced the tomato in Europe and the banana in America.

In addition to his missionary fervor, he promoted agriculture with the planting and consumption of tomatoes in the Caribbean area and the cultivation of the Dominico plantain, named in his honor.

It was from Hispaniola where men of the lineage of the man who five centuries ago expanded the gastronomic offer with the banana began their adventures and historical exploits.

Father Berlanga, as a promoter of new ideas, conceived the communication between the Atlantic and the Pacific. His plan was based on taking advantage of the waters of the Chagres River, waterway navigable up to the town of "Venta de Cruces", and linking up with the Grande River a few leagues from Panama. He proposed this project to Charles I, but the latter rejected it because of the enormous expenses required for its implementation.

Fray Pedro Córdoba

Born in Córdoba in 1482, he studied law at the University of Salamanca. In 1501 he began his religious life in the Order of St. Dominic.

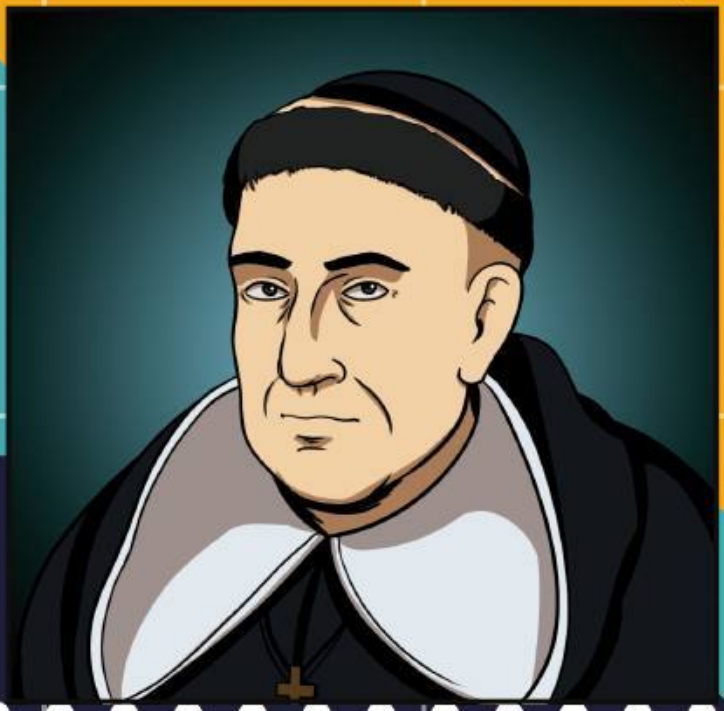
He arrived in Hispaniola in 1510, where he began his evangelizing work and established the first convent and community of his congregation in the New World.

He was the one who wrote the Advent sermon that Fray Antonio de Montesinos read on December 21, 1511, in which he denounced the harsh treatment of the indigenous people. When the viceroy Diego Columbus asked the Dominicans to retract that homily, Fray Pedro de Córdoba hardened the terms of it, warning that in the eyes of God there was no difference between Spaniards and Indians, and that all human beings were essentially equal regardless of their origin, race or color.



De Córdoba was a Pioneer of evangelization in America and a protector of the native peoples. Thanks to his struggle against the viceroy and the encomenderos, the Laws of Burgos in 1512 and the Laws of Valladolid in 1513 were established. These were the first links that led to the evolution of what we now call "human rights".

Fray Antonio de Montesinos



He was born in Castile in 1475 and died in Venezuela on June 27, 1540. He was the Spanish priest who preached in Hispaniola the famous "Advent Sermon", or "Sermon de Montesinos", in 1511.

He denounced the oppression and mistreatment suffered by the indigenous at the hands of the Spanish colonists, arguing that these peoples were comprised of persons deserving of rights, dignity and respect.

His courageous speeches laid the foundation for the debate on the rights of the people of the New World, and to this day have influenced the formulation of international law and human rights.

Hernán Cortés

Born in Medellín, Badajoz, in 1485, he died in Castilleja de la Cuesta, Seville, in 1547. Politician, soldier and writer. In 1501, he decided to embark on Nicolás de Ovando's expedition to Hispaniola, but he had a fall when he jumped a wall on a dark night, which delayed his arrival on the island until 1504, when he was 19 years old.

Once in Hispaniola, he was part of the army of Diego Velasquez, who subjugated the Indians in the Jaragua Massacre and occupied the office of the City Council of Azua, the city he helped found.

His exploits have been very controversial: some see him as a brave and visionary conquistador, while others criticize him for his alleged inhumane conduct during the conquest of Mexico.



His figure continues to be a subject of debate and investigation. In the city of Santo Domingo, where he lived, there is a house on Las Damas Street corner El Conde Street that belonged to him.

Vasco Núñez de Balboa



Balboa, considered the discoverer of the South Sea, later called the Pacific Ocean, in the year 1501, together with Rodrigo de Bastidas and the great navigator Juan de la Cosa, departed from the Iberian Peninsula, traveled the Caribbean from the east of Panama, passing through the Gulf of Urabá to Cape Vela, all these locations belonging to what would later become Colombia before the separation of Panama in 1903.

With the profits obtained in that campaign, Balboa bought a piece of land in Hispaniola, where he resided for several years, during which time he dedicated himself to agriculture and pig raising.


ARTIC OCEAN
GREENLAND
UNITED STATES OF NORTH AMERICA (ALASKA)
ICELAND
CANADA
NORWAY
NORTH IRELAND
UNITED KINGDOM
DENMARK
IRELAND
NETHERLANDS
GERMANY
FRANCE
ITALY
PORTUGAL
SPAIN
UNITED STTATES OF NORTH AMERICA
TUNISIA
MOROCCO
NORTH ATLANTIC OCEAN
ALGERIA
HISPANIOLA
MEXICO
CUBA
HAITI
JAMAICA
DOMINICAN REPUBLIC
PUERTO RICO
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MAURITANIA
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LESSER ANTILLES
GUINEA-BISSAU
GUINEA
BURKINA FASO
BENIN
NIGERIA
PACIFIC OCEAN
COSTA RICA
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GUYANA
SIERRA LEONE
IVORY COAST
GHANA
PANAMA
SURINAME
COLOMBIA
FRENCH GUIANA
LIBERIA
TOGO
CAMEROON
EQUATORIAL GUINEA
ECUADOR
GABON
PERÙ
BRASIL
ANGOLA
BOLIVIA
PARAGUAY
CHILE
ARGENTINA
URUGUAY


ARTIC OCEAN
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SWEDEN
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SOMALIA
UGANDA
KENYA
CONGO
DEMOCRATIC REPUBLIC OF CONGO
RWANDA
BURUNDI
TANZANIA
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ZIMBABWE
NAMIBIA
BOTSWANA
MADAGASCAR
ESWATINI
SOUTH AFRICA
LESOTHO
MALAYSIA
INDONESIA
PAPUA NEW GUINEA
INDIAN OCEAN
AUSTRALIA
FIJI
NEW ZEALAND
ANTARCTICA



THE TAÍNOS



WHEN THE GENOESE ADMIRAL ARRIVED ON DECEMBER 5, 1492 ON THE ISLAND OF HISPANIOLA, THIS WAS DIVIDED INTO FIVE CHIEFDOMS, THAT IS, FIVE TERRITORIES RULED BY A CACIQUE.

THE CHIEFDOMS WERE:

MARIÉN: ITS CHIEFTAIN WAS GUACANAGARIX. IT WOULD CURRENTLY COVER THE NORTHERN COAST OF HAITI AND THE DOMINICAN REPUBLIC.

MAGUÁ: ITS CHIEFTAIN WAS GUARIONEX. THIS CHIEFDOM COMPRISED THE ENTIRE NORTHEAST OF THE ISLAND AND HAD ITS MAIN SEAT NEAR THE CURRENT SANTO CERRO IN LA VEGA.

MAGUANA: ITS CHIEFTAIN WAS CAONABO. IT COMPRISED THE CENTER OF THE ISLAND AND ITS MAIN SEAT WAS THE PLACE CALLED PLAZA CEREMONIAL DE LOS INDIOS, OR CORRAL DE LOS INDIOS, IN JUAN DE HERRERA, CURRENT PROVINCE OF SAN JUAN DE LA MAGUANA.

HIGÜEY: ITS CACIQUE WAS CAYACOA. THE AREA COVERED THE ENTIRE SOUTHEASTERN PORTION OF THE ISLAND. IT HAD ITS MAIN SEAT WHERE THE CURRENT CITY OF HIGÜEY IS LOCATED. IT EXTENDED FROM CABO ENGAÑO TO THE HAINA RIVER, INCLUDING THE ISLANDS OF SAONA AND CATALINA.

JARAGUA: ITS CACIQUE WAS BOHECHÍO. WHEN BOHECHÍO DIED, HIS SISTER ANACAONA, WIFE OF CAONABO, BECAME THE FEMALE CACIQUE OF JARAGUA, WHOSE LOCATION WAS IN THE SOUTHWEST OF HISPANIOLA WITH ITS MAIN SEAT IN LA GUAYA, CURRENTLY LÉOGÂNE, NEAR PORT-AU-PRINCE, HAITI.

Caonabo

"The one who has treasures" or "Lord of the house of gold", according to the Arawak language spoken in the Lesser Antilles, which was phylogenetically related to the Taíno language.

He was the chieftain of Maguana, whose territory comprised the center of the island and whose capital was located in the Ceremonial Square of the Indians in the vicinity of the current San Juan de la Maguana.

Married to Anacaona, he destroyed the Fort Navidad, built by the Spaniards with the remains of the Santa Maria ship that had run aground on Columbus' first voyage; he also eliminated its defenders.

His courage and warrior skills caused fear in the other caciques, especially in Guacanagarix, of whom Caonabo was an enemy.





In March 1495, he tried to take the fortress of Santo Tomás that the Spaniards had built in Jánico, but he was taken prisoner by Alonso de Ojeda, who, according to Bartolomé de Las Casas in his work "Historia General de las Indias", deceived Caonabo into believing that the shackles that he placed on his wrists to subdue him were a gift that the Kings of Spain had sent him.

There are two versions of his death in 1496: one of starvation and the other refers to the shipwreck of the vessel in which he was being taken to Spain to present himself to "Their Highnesses".

Guacanagarix

He was the ruler of the chiefdom of Marién, where Admiral Christopher Columbus arrived on December 5, 1492, where he built the "Fort of Navidad" with the remains of the Santa Maria ship. The geographical area of this chiefdom extended over the northwestern portion of the island and its seat was located in a place called "El Guárico", near Cap Haitien.

Fray Bartolomé de Las Casas wrote that he was the only one of the caciques who favored the Spaniards, to whom he gave good treatment in spite of the evils they usually committed. Among other things, he collaborated with Columbus in the first military confrontation that the Europeans had with the Indians on March 24, 1495: the Battle of the Vega Real.

The effects of the war and the exploitation of the Indians reduced his chieftainship, so with the rest of the tribe that was left he went into the mountains, where he died at an unknown date.





Guacanagarix was an enemy of Caonabo because of a dispute that involved the control of the mythical space where the goddess Mother Lerma was located, in the Chiefdom of Marién.

Bohechío

Cacique of Jaragua, was the oldest Taíno chief in Hispaniola. He was brother of Anacaona, who had diplomatic gestures towards the Spaniards, and once even shared a caravel with Bartholomew Colombus, occasion during which the host ordered a cannon demonstration that frightened both and caused the laughter of the former.

He collaborated with his brother-in-law Caonabo in the destruction of the Fort of Navidad, which was located in the chiefdom of Marién, ruled by Guacanagarix.

He died in 1502 and the leadership of his chiefdom, Jaragua, was inherited by his sister Anacaona.

Cayacoa

Upon the arrival of the Spaniards to the island of Babeque or Bohío, named "Hispaniola" by Columbus on December 5, 1492, Cayacoa was the great Taíno chief of the Higüey chiefdom, a name derived from the Taíno language whose ending "güey" or "hiou" means "sun".

This chiefdom was divided into 21 Nitaínos, the noble class of the Taínos. Its main seat was located in the city of the same name, Higüey. It extended from Cabo Engaño to the Haina River, including the islands of Saona and Catalina.

The Taínos of Higüey knew agriculture and pottery, and their settlements were stable and dense, such as "El Macao".

Fray Bartolomé de Las Casas highlighted the fertility of the land in this region, whose natives, exploiting the production of yucca, turned this into the first export product from the New World to Europe.



Caonabo and Cayacoa were considered the most influential and powerful caciques on the island.

Guarionex



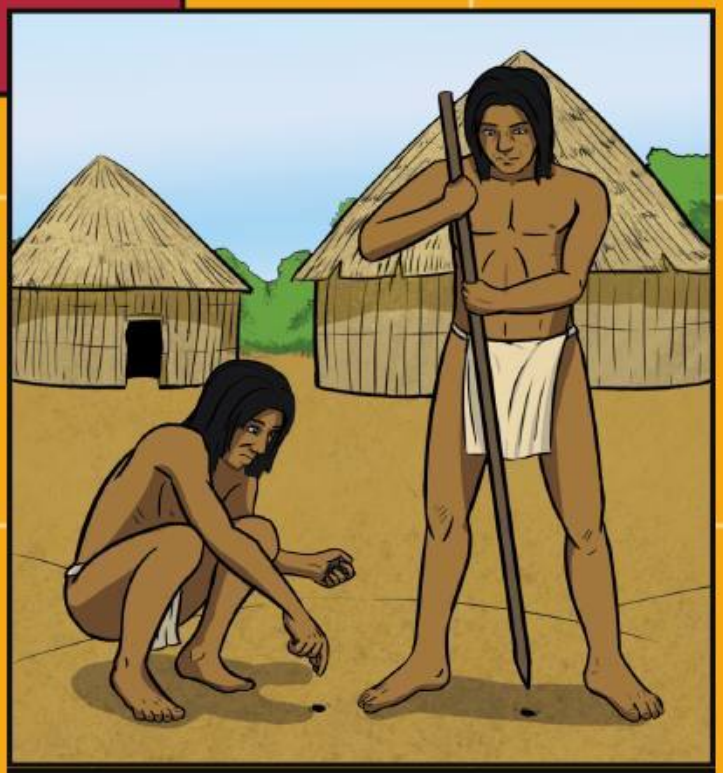
Guarionex was the chieftain of Maguá whose territory included the entire northeastern part of the island and whose main seat was located near the present Santo Cerro in La Vega. In the Taíno language, the name Guarionex means "brave and noble lord".

This cacique revolted on several occasions against the Spaniards and ended up as a prisoner of Bartholomew Columbus. In this condition, he was shipped to Spain, but died in 1502 in the shipwreck of the vessel that would take him there.

Taíno customs

The Taínos were originally from the Orinoco area in South America and reached the Caribbean by sailing from island to island in their canoes. In the Arawak language, the term "Taíno" means "good" or "noble".

The clothing worn by the Taínos corresponded to the tropical environment in which their culture was found: men wore a simple "loincloth" and married women wore an apron of straw, cotton or leaves called "naguas". On the other hand, unmarried women did not wear any type of clothing. Instead, they used to apply body paint in the colors black, red, white and yellow, which was also customary for men. Another of their traditions was to decorate their bodies with religious tattoos and to wear ornaments made of gold, silver, stones, bones and shells on their ears and lips.

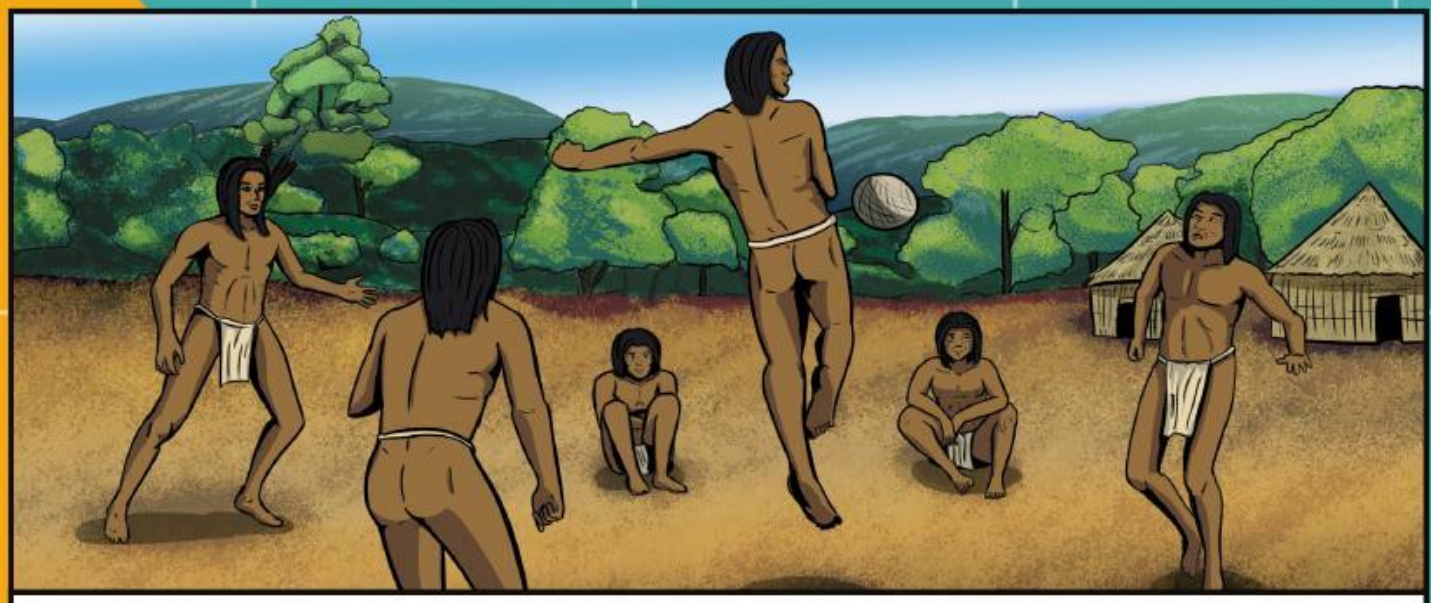


The main economic activity of the Taínos was agriculture. The area of plantations was called "conuco". Among their main crops were sweet potatoes, potatoes, corn, peanuts, peppers, pineapples and tobacco.



The Taínos used to live in dwellings they called "bohíos", a circular windowless hut generally made of straw, wood and mud, common to the inhabitants of the yucayeque, name given to the communities of considerable size, that is to say, of more than 50 dwellings of different sizes.

Naturally, it included the cacique's dwelling, which was called "caney". This was the largest of the complex, rectangular in shape and had windows.



The Taínos had fun with music, dance and the ball game called "batú", which was practiced in a rectangular space called "batey".

It is estimated that at the arrival of the Spaniards there was a population of 230,000 inhabitants on the island.



The main god of the Taíno people was Yocahu Bagua.

Maorocoti, Yucuyi, god of good, son of the goddess Atabey. It was believed that Juracan, from where the term "hurricane" comes, was the bad god.

The Taínos believed in supernatural beings that they called "cemíes", which they represented in the form of idols made of stone, wood or clay.

To this day, many Taíno words are still used, including anón, areito, arepa, barbacoa, batata, batey, bija, bohío, boricua, cacique, canoa, carey, caribe, casabe, cayuco, cocuyo, comején, conuco, dajao, fotuto, güira, guanikeyu, guaraguao, guasábara, guayaba, güiro, hamaca, huracán, hutía, iguana, jagua, jatibonicu, jíbaro, macana, macuto, maní, naiboa, nigua, orocobix, piragua, quemí, sabana, taíno, tiburón, yaguasa and zunzún.



Anacaona

Anacaona, which in Taíno means "Golden Flower", was the female cacique of Jaragua and Maguana.

She was famous for her elegance, beauty and peculiar way of reciting poetry, as well as for singing in the areítos, a religious ritual that the Taínos celebrated in the caney, the cacique's residence, where they also danced.

When her brother Bohechío and her husband Caonabo died, she took charge of governing their respective chiefdoms, Maguana and Jaragua, which made her the most powerful woman on the island.

She was the mother of Higuemota, whom she supported in her sentimental relationship with the Spaniard Hernando de Guevara. This couple procreated a daughter whom they named Mencía.



In spite of her attempts to make a pact with the Spaniards, Anacaona organized a resistance with effective attacks against Nicolás de Ovando due to the abuse they committed against the natives.



Anacaona had taken refuge in her lands in Jaragua and there, in 1503, Nicolás de Ovando sent her some "emissaries of peace", which was nothing more than a vulgar deception. The female cacique had prepared a real welcome party for them, which the Spaniards "thanked" by murdering the natives who attended the event. This tragic incident is known as "The Jaragua Massacre".

Anacaona was brought before Governor Ovando, who gave orders that she be tortured. She was then subjected to a "trial" which, naturally, resulted in her sentence to death by hanging. As a warning to the natives, her body was exhibited to the public.

Higuemota

Daughter of the cacique Caonabo and Anacaona, survivor of the Jaragua Massacre, marked the historical milestone of miscegenation when she married the Spaniard Hernando de Guevara, with whom she gave birth to Mencía, who would become the wife of cacique Enriquillo.

The Spanish writer Luis García Jambrina, in his book titled "Manuscrito del Aire", inspired by Higuemota, tells us the following: "Higuemota is a very peculiar woman, because she married a Spaniard, Hernando de Guevara, and for that she had to be baptized: that made her live between two worlds, the Taíno and the Christian".



As we can see, the first person that the writings of the time indicate as a precursor of interbreeding among persons of different races is a woman who knew both the Taíno world and the Spanish world.

Mencía



The offense of the Spanish encomendero Andres de Valenzuela, based in San Juan de la Maguana, gave rise to the rebellion of her husband Enriquillo, whom she accompanied in the mountains of Neiba and Bahoruco.

Daughter of Higuemota and Hernando de Guevara, a Spaniard who came on Christopher Columbus' third voyage. Higuemota and Hernando were so charmed by Cupid that they asked to be married in church.

The first mestiza recorded in America was present at the Slaughter of Jaragua in 1503, but survived. She was educated by the Spaniards, so she learned to read and write. Like her husband, the cacique Guarocuya, better known as Enriquillo, she was protected by Bartolomé de Las Casas.

When her husband Enriquillo died in 1535, Mencía assumed the title of "cacique", becoming the last indigenous queen: our last female cacique.

Hatuey

The first rebel of America was a Taíno cacique and tribal chief. He was born in 1478 in the place that the Spaniards called Lares de Guahaba. After the Osorio devastations of 1605 and 1606, this place came to be known as Hincha.

Upon the arrival of the Europeans, the cacique Hatuey moved to the eastern zone of the island of Cuba, and there he advised and warned his settlers about the interests of the conquerors.

According to Fray Bartolomé de Las Casas, Hatuey, showing gold nuggets to the Taínos of the Caobana area in Cuba, expressed to them the following: "This is the god that the Spaniards worship; for these they fight and kill; for these they persecute us and that is why we have to throw them into the sea... They tell us, these tyrants, that they worship a god of peace and equality, but they usurp our lands and make us their slaves.





They tell us of an immortal soul and its eternal rewards and punishments, but they steal our belongings, seduce our women, rape our daughters. Unable to match us in courage, these cowards cover themselves with iron that our weapons cannot break."

After being at the head of several tribes in the eastern region of Cuba, Hatuey was taken prisoner and condemned to the most infamous death, which was that of the stake, in what today would be Yara, a municipality in the province of Granma.

On February 2, 1513, the priest asked Hatuey, before he was burned, if he wanted to become a Christian in order to ascend to heaven. The latter answered him with the following question: "And do the Spaniards also go to heaven?" Upon receiving from the priest the affirmative answer, he said without hesitation, "I do not want to go there but to hell, so as not to be where they are and not to see such cruel people".

Osema

Osema, baptized by the Spaniards as Catalina, was the widow of the cacique of Higüey, Cayacoa.

There is a story about the gold mines of Haina that tells that Miguel Diaz de Aux, believing he had killed another Spaniard in a fight, fled until he reached the banks of the Ozama in the chiefdom of Higüey, where he met Osema. She confided the secret about the gold mines and Miguel Diaz returned. When he told the Spaniards about the mines he was pardoned, turning this fact into a catalyst for the founding of the city of Santo Domingo.



Enriquillo

Born in 1498 in the chiefdom of Jaragua. From 1519 to 1532 he rose up in rebellion in the Sierra de Bahoruco against the authorities of Hispaniola, until the arrival from Spain of Francisco Barrionuevo, representing King Charles V of the Holy Roman-Germanic Empire. Thus, Enriquillo and Francisco Barrionuevo signed the first peace treaty in the New World.

One of Enriquillo's protectors was Fray Bartolomé de Las Casas and, sponsored by his encomendero Francisco Valenzuela, in San Juan de la Maguana, he learned to read and write, to ride horses and even to speak some English and German, according to the chronicles of the time.



The Spanish crown granted him the title of "Don", so he was called "Don Enrique". Historians agree that Guarocuya and Enriquillo were the same person.

First court case for mistreatment of the Indians

In his work "La Española, Epicenter of the Caribbean in the 16th Century", Spanish historian Esteban Mira Caballos gathers from the essay "El Pleito Diego Colón-Francisco de Solís" the first trial for mistreatment of the Indians.



In the Villa de Santiago, which belonged to the Concepción de la Vega, Juan Carrillo, who was the mayor of La Vega, initiated the lawsuit on October 20, 1509. It is suspected that the one who denounced the deaths was the Visitor of Indians during Ovando's time, Diego de Marchena.

During the process testimonies of several witnesses were heard, among which were friends of the accused: Spanish workers of the hacienda "La Esperanza", where the events took place; Indian declarants; as well as other Spanish witnesses who simply recounted the events as they had seen them.

The sentence was passed on August 15, 1510 by the mayor of Hispaniola Marcos de Aguilar. The accused Francisco de Solis was notified of the sentence three days later: "That for the whipping to death of the two Indians, he was sentenced to banishment from the Villa de Santiago and the loss of his encomienda". According to Professor Mira Caballos, the ruling was appealed to the Royal Council, and was presented in Seville on March 26, 1511.

This sentence seems to have been ratified by the Royal Council. By 1514 Solis, the sentenced man, was residing in Santo Domingo; then he left for Cuba and from there to Mexico.

Facts: Did Taínos disappear?



The indigenous population was in danger of extinction due more to disease than to the mistreatment inflicted on them, as Dominican historian Orlando Inoa reveals: "In 1571, Archbishop Fr. Andrés de Caryajal told Felipe II: "There is another Indian village eight leagues from this city, called Boyá, which would have twenty-five neighbors, all old and poor and without children. The place is new, established by a religious of San Agustin who brought there those Indians from those mountains and made them a straw church". In 1650 Alcocer wrote: "The town of Boyá, which is comprised of Indians descended from those of this island, would have about six houses in it".

As recorded in the July 31, 1556 seat of the Council of the Indies:

"Last year four Indian villages, of which there were news, were discovered in Hispaniola. The one near Puerto de Plata, the other on that coast further on, in the province that used to be called Ciguayos; another on the cape of the island that looks towards Cuba by the cape of Saint-Nicolas".

The discovery of a thousand-year-old woman's tooth found in a cave on the island of Eleuthera, in the Bahamas, has made it possible to sequence the first complete human genome in the Caribbean. This is a fascinating fact: many history books say that the indigenous population of the Caribbean was virtually wiped out, but people who identify themselves as Taínos have always advocated for continuity. "Now we know they were right all along," says Hannes Schroeder of the University of Copenhagen, Denmark, lead author of the study and part of the Nexus 1492 Project to learn about the region's indigenous heritage.

Did you know...

Alonso de Ojeda, a warrior during the capture of Granada by the Catholic Monarchs in 1492, was a Spanish navigator, governor and conqueror who gave his name to Venezuela.

Accompanied by Juan de la Cosa and Amerigo Vespucci in an expedition that sailed from Spain on May 18, 1499, he discovered the island of Curacao, which he called "Island of the Giants" because he believed he had seen Taínos of great stature. He also discovered Lake Maracaibo and almost the entire Venezuelan coast.

He arrived in America on Columbus' second voyage and was present at the founding of the first city in the New World, La Isabela, on January 6, 1494.



Alonso De Ojeda



By order of the admiral, he was sent to explore the Cibao, where he found gold. Upon his return, he was given the task of helping the Catalan Pedro de Marguerite, who commanded the Santo Tomás de Jánico fortress, which was under attack by the cacique Caonabo. Ojeda deceived Caonabo by putting shackles on Caonabo after telling him that such chackles were a "gift". Once immobilized, Caonabo was incarcerated.

Ojeda married the Venezuelan princess Guaricha, baptized with the name of "Isabel" in honor of Queen Isabel the Catholic, and had three children with her.

After the failure and the great difficulties he had on his last trip, Ojeda decided to lock himself in the Monastery of San Francisco, located in Santo Domingo, Dominican Republic. In 1510, he asked that when he died his body be placed under the main door of the monastery, so that all those who entered the church would step on it, in an act of humility that expressed his regret for the mistakes he made in life.



His wife appeared every day at the doors of the monastery until, very soon after Ojeda's death, she was found dead on the place where he had been buried.

The remains of both were requested many times by different Venezuelan governments, but were always denied by different Dominican governments. During the Civil War of 1965, they were stolen and in 1982 a Spanish priest took them to Ciudad Ojeda, Venezuela, on the eastern shore of Lake Maracaibo, where a memorial containing their remains was erected.

In their honor, the Spanish writer, journalist and politician Vicente Blasco Ibanez wrote the book "El Caballero de la Virgen" (The Knight of the Virgin).

It was in the city of Santo Domingo where a man of Ojeda's dimensions decided to retire and wished to be buried, although the vagaries of existence determined that his remains were stolen and transferred to where he did not wish them to be, but in Hispaniola



SELLECT THE RIGHT ANSWER

1- WHO DREW THE FIRST MAP OF THE ISLAND OF HISPANIOLA?

- A) Juan de la Cosa
- B) Christopher Columbus

2- WHERE WERE THE CAPITULATIONS OF SANTA FE SIGNED?

- A) Cipango
- B) Avila
- C) Granada

3- WHAT WAS THE FIRST VILLAGE IN AMERICA?

- A) Santo Domingo
- B) La Isabela
- C) Azua

4- WHAT WAS THE NAME OF THE FIRST MESTIZO?

- A) Miguel Diaz de Aux, the young
- B) Hernán Cortés
- C) Nicolás de Ovando

5- WHO WAS THE FIRST WOMAN RULER IN AMERICA?

- A) Isabella I The Catholic
- B) Maria de Toledo
- C) Higuemota

6- WHAT PRODUCT DID NEW GUINEA BRING TO HISPANIOLA?

- A) Sugar cane
- B) Plantain
- C) Cocoa

7- WHO WAS THE FIRST SUGAR PRODUCER IN AMERICA?

- A) Gonzalez Fernandez de Oviedo
- B) Pedro de Atienza
- C) Miguel Ballester

8- WHEN DID CHRISTOPHER COLUMBUS ARRIVE IN HISPANIOLA?

- A) December 5, 1492
- B) December 6, 1493
- C) November 5, 1492

9- CAONABO...

A) Destroyed Fort of La Navidad

B) Had negotiation skills with other caciques

C) He was a Batú player

10- WHICH WOMAN ORGANIZED A RESISTANCE AGAINST THE SPANIARDS DUE TO THE ABUSE AGAINST THE NATIVES IN HISPANIOLA?

A) Mencía

B) Anacaona

C) Higuemota

11- WHO WAS THE FIRST REBEL IN AMERICA?

A) Hatuey

B) Cayacoa

C) Bohechío

12- WHERE DID THE TAINOS COME FROM?

A) The Lesser Antilles

B) South America

C) Central America

13- WHAT WAS THE COMMON DWELLING OF THE TAINOS?

A) Caney

B) Bohío

C) Hut

14- WHO WAS THE MAIN GOD OF THE TAINOS?

A) Maorocoti

B) Atabey

C) Yocahu Bagua

15- WHO TOLD MIGUEL DIAZ DE AUX ABOUT THE GOLD MINES IN HAINA?

A) Cayacoa

B) Anacaona

C) Osema

16- WHY DID THE FIRST JUDICIAL PROCESS INVOLVING THE INDIANS TAKE PLACE?

A) Because of the bad treatment given to the Indians

B) For the ownership of the lands on the island of Hispaniola

C) Because of rebellions on the island against the Spaniards

17- WHO WROTE THE ADVENT SERMON?

A) Fray Antonio de Montesinos

B) Fray Tomás Berlanga

C) Fray Pedro de Córdoba

18- WHO OCCUPIED THE OFFICE OF AZUA'S NOTARY PUBLIC?

A) Vasco Núñez de Balboa

B) Hernán Cortés

C) Miguel Diaz de Aux the Elder

ANSWERS:

1 - B, 2 - C, 3 - B, 4 - A, 5 - B, 6 - A, 7 - A, 8 - A, 9 - A, 10 - B, 11 - A, 12 - B, 13 - B, 14 - C, 15 - C, 16 - A, 17 - C, 18 - B

KAH KOW

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